

OAKLINE FURNITURE PRIVATE LIMITED

New Joiner and Employment Handbook

Fictional policy document prepared for training and RAG testing

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Policy owner	People and Culture
Applies to	All permanent, probationary, fixed-term and trainee employees in India

Important: This is a fictional internal policy corpus. It is not legal advice and should not be adopted without review under applicable employment, tax, privacy, safety, and local labor laws.

1. Purpose and scope

This handbook explains the employment rules a new employee is expected to understand from the date of joining. It covers onboarding, probation, confirmation, working conduct, notice period, separation, early departure, records, benefits administration and escalation channels. Where a letter of appointment provides a more favorable term, the appointment letter will apply. Where law requires a more favorable term, the law will apply.

2. Definitions

Term	Meaning
Business day	A day on which the employee's assigned office, showroom, warehouse or factory is scheduled to operate.
Reporting manager	The manager recorded in the HR information system (HRIS) or a formally assigned delegate.
Probation	The initial assessment period before employment confirmation.
Notice period	The minimum advance written notice required to end employment.
Early release	Management-approved separation before completion of the applicable notice period.
Job abandonment	Unexplained absence for three consecutive scheduled working days after reasonable contact attempts.

3. Pre-joining and first-day requirements

- Employees must submit identity, address, bank, tax, education and prior-employment records requested in the joining checklist. Original documents may be viewed for verification but will not be retained unless legally required.
- Any mismatch, expired document or missing relieving letter must be disclosed before joining. HR may allow a conditional joining period of up to 30 calendar days for non-critical documents.
- Employees must complete confidentiality, acceptable-use, code-of-conduct and conflict-of-interest declarations before access to production systems, customer data, pricing data or factory-controlled areas is granted.
- Background verification may continue after joining. Material falsification, undisclosed concurrent employment, forged records or intentional concealment may lead to withdrawal of employment or disciplinary action after due review.

4. Probation and confirmation

The standard probation period is six months from the date of joining. Management may confirm an employee earlier after a minimum of three completed months, or extend probation once by up to three additional months where performance, attendance, conduct, role clarity, training completion or business exposure is insufficient for a fair decision.

Stage	Normal timing	What happens
30-day check-in	Day 25-35	Role clarity, induction completion, early support needs and initial attendance review.
90-day review	Day 80-100	Progress against goals, product/process knowledge and behavior feedback.
Confirmation review	Before end of month 6	Manager recommendation, HR compliance review and confirmation decision.
Extended probation review	Before revised end date	Final assessment and written decision.

Confirmation is valid only when communicated in writing by HR. Continued work after the planned probation end date does not automatically confirm employment. During probation, either party may normally terminate employment with 15 calendar days' written notice or salary in lieu, subject to the appointment letter and applicable law.

5. Working hours, attendance and punctuality

Corporate office employees normally work Monday to Friday, 9:30 a.m. to 6:30 p.m., including a one-hour meal break. Showroom, warehouse and factory teams may work rostered shifts across six operating days with weekly rest as scheduled. Employees must record attendance through the approved system and must not mark attendance for another person.

- A delay of up to 10 minutes may be treated as a grace occurrence, not an entitlement. Repeated lateness may trigger counseling even when each delay is within the grace window.

- Three late arrivals exceeding 10 minutes in a calendar month may be treated as one half-day attendance exception unless the manager regularizes them for documented operational or emergency reasons.
- Employees must notify their manager as soon as reasonably possible and preferably before shift start when absent or delayed.
- Overtime must be pre-approved. Eligibility for overtime pay or compensatory time depends on role classification, location and applicable law.

6. Leaving work early and short permission

A short permission allows an employee to arrive late or leave early for a genuine personal need without recording a half-day, provided business coverage is maintained.

Rule	Standard
Maximum duration	Up to 2 hours in a working day.
Frequency	Normally no more than two permissions in a calendar month.
Approval	Prior approval from reporting manager through HRIS/email/chat record; emergency verbal approval must be documented the same day.
Minimum work	Employee should complete at least 6 working hours that day unless the manager approves half-day leave or work-from-home.
Restricted situations	Not normally allowed during mandatory training, customer installation, stock count, dispatch cutoff, audit, safety drill or critical production activity.
Repeated use	May be converted to half-day leave or unpaid time when limits are exceeded without exceptional approval.

An employee who becomes unwell at work may leave after informing the manager or shift supervisor. For safety-sensitive factory or driving roles, the supervisor may arrange safe transport or medical evaluation. No employee should operate machinery or drive on company duty while medically unfit.

7. Workplace conduct and professional standards

- Treat colleagues, workers, customers, vendors and visitors with dignity. Harassment, bullying, discrimination, threats, retaliation, abusive language and unwanted sexual conduct are prohibited.
- Do not offer or accept bribes, kickbacks, secret commissions or improper benefits. Nominal business gifts must comply with the gift and conflict-of-interest rules.
- Disclose outside employment, directorship, vendor relationship, close-relative reporting relationship or financial interest that may create a conflict.
- Company designs, drawings, bill of materials, pricing, customer lists, supplier terms, production methods and unpublished product plans are confidential.
- Dress must be clean, safe and appropriate for the assigned workplace. PPE and uniform rules apply in designated operational areas.

- Photography and video recording are prohibited in design, prototype, warehouse, factory and customer-data areas unless authorized.

8. Performance, training and role changes

Employees are expected to complete assigned induction, safety, product, information-security and anti-harassment training. Performance goals may include quality, productivity, customer outcomes, teamwork, process compliance and learning. A role, reporting line, shift, workstation or work location may be reasonably changed according to business need, skills and contractual terms. Permanent transfers involving a material location change will be documented.

9. Notice period and resignation

Employment status	Employee resignation notice	Company termination notice (ordinary, non-misconduct)
Probation / extended probation	15 calendar days	15 calendar days or pay in lieu
Confirmed employee - grades O1 to M2	30 calendar days	30 calendar days or pay in lieu
Confirmed employee - grades M3 and above	60 calendar days	60 calendar days or pay in lieu
Fixed-term employee	As stated in contract	As stated in contract and law

Resignation must be submitted in writing through HRIS or official email. The notice period begins on the date HR or the reporting manager receives a clear, unconditional resignation. Leave during notice is not automatic and may extend the last working day unless HR approves otherwise. The company may waive all or part of notice, require the employee not to attend work while remaining employed, or accept salary in lieu, subject to handover and legal requirements.

10. Early release, notice buyout and waiver

- Employees may request early release by stating the proposed last working day, reason, handover plan, open deliverables and whether notice buyout is requested.
- Approval depends on project continuity, replacement readiness, customer commitments, stock/audit cycles, access risk, recovery of company property and contractual restrictions.
- Notice buyout is calculated on fixed monthly gross salary unless the appointment letter states another basis. Incentives, bonus, overtime, reimbursements and employer contributions are excluded.
- The company may fully or partially waive notice at its discretion. A waiver is not a precedent for other employees.
- No employee may unilaterally set an early last working day by offering payment. Release is effective only when HR confirms it in writing.

11. Separation clearance and final settlement

1. Complete knowledge transfer and handover documents approved by the manager.
2. Return laptop, phone, access card, keys, tools, samples, drawings, documents, PPE, vehicle, payment cards and any other company property.

3. Settle advances, loans, notice shortfall, damaged/lost property recoveries where lawful, and approved expense claims.
4. Remove company data from personal devices and confirm that no confidential copies are retained.
5. Complete exit interview and contact/bank details for final settlement.

The target for full and final settlement is within 45 calendar days after the last working day, or earlier where applicable law requires. Experience and relieving letters may be issued after essential clearance, subject to company records and legal requirements.

12. Discipline and investigation

Minor concerns may be addressed through coaching, documented counseling or warnings. Serious or repeated misconduct may result in investigation, suspension pending inquiry, final warning or termination. Examples include theft, fraud, violence, deliberate safety breach, data theft, bribery, serious harassment, intoxication in a safety-sensitive role, falsification of records and unauthorized disclosure. The employee will normally be informed of the concern and given a reasonable opportunity to respond, except where immediate action is required for safety or legal reasons.

13. Grievance, whistleblowing and escalation

- Routine employment concern: reporting manager, then HR Business Partner.
- Harassment concern: Internal Committee or designated prevention-of-harassment channel.
- Fraud, bribery, theft, serious safety or data concern: confidential ethics channel or Head of Compliance.
- Employees must not face retaliation for a good-faith report or participation in an investigation.

14. Acknowledgement

Employees must acknowledge that they have received, read and understood this handbook.

Acknowledgement confirms awareness, not agreement to unlawful terms. Policies may be updated with reasonable notice.